

in the background to make the two dots move on the path one by one. As the difficulty of the game rises, so does the amount of inputs and their specific timing and hence, the two dots look like they're dancing to the beat of the music - hence the name, A Dance of Fire and Ice. The levels serve as the tutorials for the theme of the world. One world will be based on just offbeat music or one world will contain just S-shaped paths (trust us, those were a pain in the butt to pass). After you clear these levels, there will be the boss level which will combine everything that you would have learnt in the previous levels. ADOFAI is a perma-death game. Hence, if you fail at any point during the level, if you miss once, it is game over and you gotta restart that level.

In terms of difficulty, this game ranks a bit higher than Rhythm Doctor. Although it is a single-input game like Rhythm Doctor, it gets a bit more complicated when you start climbing the ranks. As you progress through the game, the levels will get more complicated and hence, sometimes, two or three inputs in rapid succession will be required (or even more). The game also has 'Speed Up' and 'Slow Down' feature where if you encounter a snail icon, the BPM of the currently playing song will be cut in half. If you encounter a rabbit, the BPM will rapidly rise up. ADOFAI is a game where stuff gets real complicated, real quick. It will take a lot of retries just to clear one level. Heck, sometimes you won't even be able to figure out the rhythm of the upcoming S-bend or curve. Hence, ADOFAI has a bit of a learning curve attached to it but once you are accustomed to the mechanics of the game, it can get pretty fun too.

Muse Dash

Muse Dash is a catch game in general. It has catchy songs, catchy characters and catchy game design. How? Well, for starters there isn't even a mention of a muted color palette in the game's colors. Everything is brightly colored in shades of yellow

and red. Then there are the girls, the main characters of the game. Each girl comes with it's own powerups that will help you in the game. There are different versions of each girl - each having a signature powerup. Muse Dash is a map-based game, meaning it has maps with several difficulties for a certain song. If you are a beginner, you can start from the low stars gradually going for the high starred maps. It is a 2D side scroller game, where the girl keeps on running and keeps smashing the obstacles that come in her way, obviously to the beat of the song. How will she smash the obstacles you ask? Well, the obstacles will either appear on the top or the bottom and to hit them, you'll have to assign a key for each. There will be two circles in front of your girl. One will be at the top and the other will be at the bottom. You will have to hit the obstacle exactly when it is at the centre of the circle. You either do that or you can pay no heed to the circles and hit the obstacles to the beat of the song. Hence, this is a two-keyed game. You can assign more than one key to the top and the bottom for maps with high obstacle density.

Unlike the past two games, Muse Dash requires multiple keys to operate and that's what makes it a bit difficult to play. You have to have very strong hand-eye coordination with both of your hands to hit the obstacles in time. The game gets pretty hard, pretty fast and hence it is a game which is easy to pick up but difficult to play for a long time. Sure, you will pass the 1-2 star levels in your first try. But the crux of the game and the main enjoyment of the game lies in passing and eventually Full Combing the higher starred level.

OSU!

This weird named rhythm game is probably the hardest of the bunch. In Osu! You have to click the circles to the beat of the song. Sounds simple, right? Nah! There are a ton of things that play a huge factor in making this game a bit more difficult than the

rest. For starters, to click the circle, you will have to aim on it. To aim, you will have to use your mouse to take your cursor there and with the other hand, you will have to tap. The game strictly accepts only two inputs. Key 1 and Key 2. Ofcourse, both keys can be set to any two keys you want. For the aiming part, you can either use a mouse or a drawing tablet. Yes, a drawing tablet. Just like Muse Dash, Osu! is a map based game with difficulty of a certain map being counted in stars. Hence, the higher star the map is, the more difficult it is. There are other mechanics like jumps - where you have to hit the circles in rapid succession which can be very far apart from each other, streams - where the circles are so close that you will have to alternate between pressing the two keys in rapid succession to hit them. Oh, and to correctly time your hit, there will be another bigger circle that will close down onto your main circle and you are supposed to hit the circle when both the circles meet. If all of this seems very far-fetched for you, don't worry. You will eventually get the hang of it.

All the games included in this list use just a keyboard as the main controlling mechanic of the game. But the introduction of aiming with your mouse or tablet adds an extra layer of difficulty to the game. Many people will not be able to pass even 1-2 star maps on their first try just because of how steep the learning curve toward the game is. The reward is worth it. The adrenaline rush you get when you Full Combo a high star map is unmatched. You can even apply certain mods to change up the gameplay a bit and to get a higher score. For example, the Double Time mod will speed up the music by 1.25x or the Hard Rock mod will make everything just a bit harder.

Conclusion

These were the four games that we think you should play if you are absolutely new to the genre. Do note that these games are extremely input sensitive, so use good gear. *